SEXUAL & REPRODUCTIVE HEALTH

Kisspeptin — the full review

REPRODUCTIVE SIGNALING PEPTIDE (KISSPEPTIN-10)

This is the deeper look behind the short version — how the reproductive hormone chain works, what the Imperial College trials measured, why kisspeptin-10 and kisspeptin-54 are not interchangeable, and what your consultation covers.

What it is

Kisspeptin is a natural signaling peptide made in the hypothalamus that sits at the top of the reproductive hormone chain — it tells the brain to release GnRH (gonadotropin-releasing hormone), which sets the rest of the hormonal sequence in motion down to testosterone and estrogen.

It is used by people interested in libido, sexual desire, and reproductive hormone signaling.

What people use it for

USED FOR	EVIDENCE	WHAT THAT MEANS
Low sexual desire	**Limited human data**	Hospital studies at Imperial College London measured brain response to sexual stimuli.
Fertility support and ovulation triggering	**Human trials**	The strongest evidence, from IVF trials — using a longer form given intravenously.
Testosterone and reproductive hormone support	**Limited human data**	Kisspeptin reliably raises LH; whether that translates to a durable testosterone effect is less settled.

How it works

Kisspeptin neurons in the hypothalamus are now understood to be the master regulator that triggers GnRH release, which in turn stimulates the pituitary to release luteinizing hormone (LH) and follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH) — the hormones that drive testosterone production in men and the ovulatory cycle in women. This places kisspeptin upstream of the entire reproductive hormone axis.

Because of this position at the top of the hormonal chain, kisspeptin has also been studied for its direct effects on brain regions involved in sexual arousal and desire, separate from its role in the downstream hormone cascade.

What the research actually looked at

Hospital studies at Imperial College London have measured brain response to sexual stimuli in people given kisspeptin, providing limited but real human evidence for a role in sexual desire. Kisspeptin reliably raises LH in these studies, but whether that translates into a durable testosterone or reproductive hormone effect is less settled.

The strongest evidence for kisspeptin comes from fertility and IVF trials, where a longer-acting form given intravenously has been used to trigger ovulation — a different form and route from what is typically offered for libido or hormone-support use, and a distinction worth keeping in mind when interpreting the evidence.

Common misunderstandings

- **“All the kisspeptin evidence applies to any form of the peptide.”** The strongest fertility evidence comes from IVF trials using a longer form (kisspeptin-54) given intravenously — not the same as kisspeptin-10, which is what is typically offered outside a fertility clinic; kisspeptin-10 and kisspeptin-54 are not interchangeable.
- **“It's a proven testosterone booster.”** Kisspeptin reliably raises LH in studies, but whether that produces a durable testosterone benefit is less settled.
- **“It's approved for libido or fertility use.”** Kisspeptin has never been approved for any use, in any country.
- **“It has nothing to do with anti-doping rules.”** Kisspeptin is named on the WADA Prohibited List, which is a real consideration for anyone in tested sport.

Who it is not for

- Anyone with a hormone-sensitive cancer — prostate, breast, ovarian or endometrial.
- Anyone being treated with a GnRH agonist or antagonist, for any reason.
- Anyone trying to conceive or on fertility treatment who is not under the care of a fertility specialist.
- Anyone with a hormone or pituitary disorder, and anyone in tested sport.

Competitive athletes: Kisspeptin is named on the WADA Prohibited List. Anyone in tested sport should treat this as disqualifying for use, regardless of the intended purpose.

Who makes this, and under what rules

Everything dispensed here is prepared by a licensed 503A compounding pharmacy — not bought from a supplier and repackaged, and not sourced from an online seller.

That designation carries specific, enforceable obligations:

- **A prescription in your name.** Compounded from a prescription for one identified patient, after an evaluation.
- **Licensed and inspected.** A state licence, subject to inspection by the state board of pharmacy.
- **Ingredients that can be traced.** A certificate of analysis from an FDA-registered facility, back to a named source and lot.
- **Sterile preparation to a published standard.** USP standards.
- **A paper trail.** A lot number and beyond-use date on every preparation.

A compounded preparation is not an FDA-approved medicine — but it is the difference between a licensed pharmacy working to a standard and an unregulated website.

Where this stands

Never approved anywhere.

The human research is real but early. Mostly in controlled research settings.

Being studied by serious researchers is not the same as being established as a treatment.

Clinical detail

Kisspeptin-10 is the fragment most often used outside fertility-clinic settings; kisspeptin-54 is a longer-acting form used in IVF protocols.

Sits upstream of GnRH in the reproductive hormone cascade, making it the regulator that initiates the entire downstream hormone sequence.

Human brain-imaging and sexual-response studies conducted at Imperial College London.

Longer-acting kisspeptin-54, given intravenously, has been used in IVF trials to trigger ovulation.

Named on the WADA Prohibited List.

The information on this page is general education. It is not medical advice and it is not a recommendation for any treatment.

Kisspeptin is not an FDA-approved medicine for the uses described here. A compounded preparation is not an FDA-approved product and has not been reviewed by the FDA for safety, effectiveness or quality.

Descriptions of what this is used for reflect how it is commonly used and discussed. They are not claims that it is effective for any purpose.

Any prescription follows an individual evaluation by a licensed provider and is issued only where that provider judges it clinically appropriate. A prescription is never guaranteed.